Revisiting the continuum model of tendon pathology: what is its merit in clinica

Cook JL, Rio E, Purdam CR, Docking SI â British Journal of Sports Medicine (BJSM) (2016)

Clinical Focus: Tendinopathy | Open Access Clinical Reference

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1. The Staged Continuum Paradigm

The continuum model of tendon pathology differentiates load-induced presentation into three continuous stages:

â¢ Reactive Tendinopathy: Acute, non-inflammatory cellular response to tensile or compressive load spike.

â¢ Tendon Disrepair: Focal matrix disruption, chondrocytic cell proliferation, and capillary ingrowth.

â¢ Degenerative Tendinopathy: Disorganized collagen matrix with large areas of cell death and minimal repair capacity.

2. Clinical Load Management & Treatment Strategies

â¢ Reactive stage priority: Load management. Reduce high-tensile energy-storage activities (jumping, sprinting).

â¢ Isometric holds (5 x 45 seconds at 70% MVC) produce immediate cortical inhibition and reliable analgesic relief.

â¢ Heavy Slow Resistance (HSR) training (3 x weekly, 3-4 sets of 6-8 RM) promotes positive collagen mechanical adaptation.

â¢ Energy storage and release training must be reintroduced progressively before return-to-sport clearance.

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